

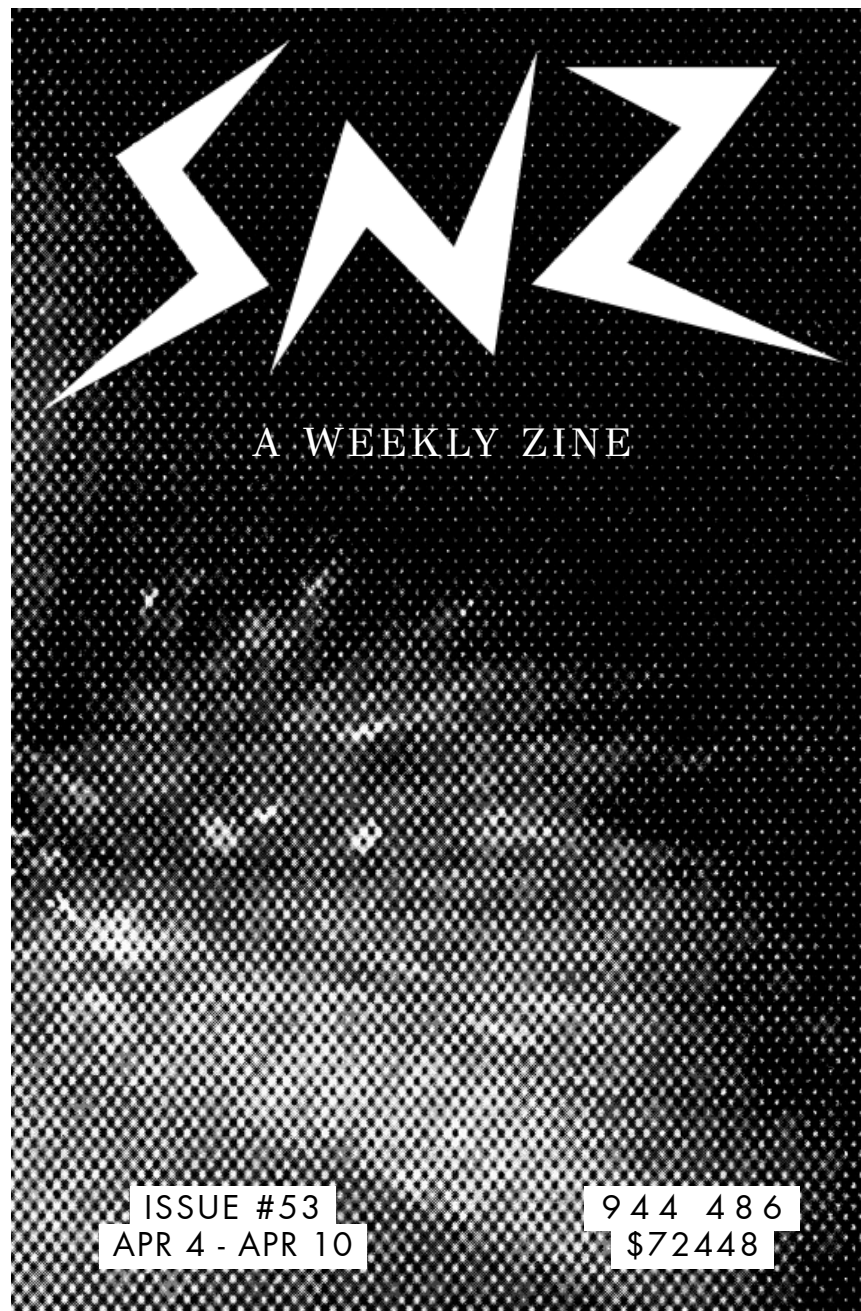
Join the Stacker Sports MLB survivor pool

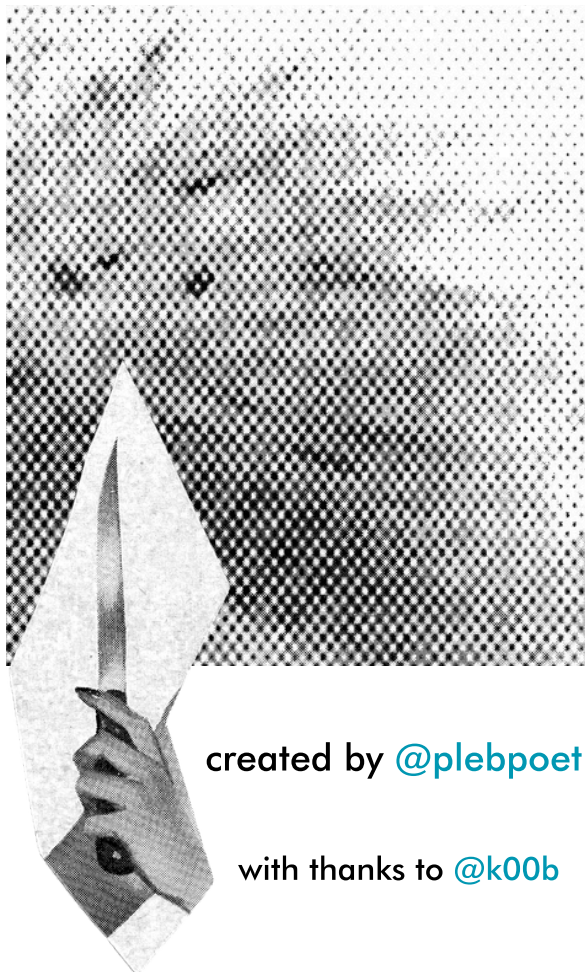
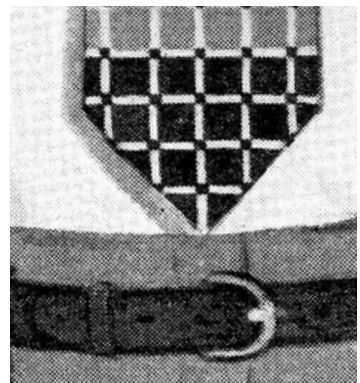


STACKER NEWS

THE ZAPPINGEST LITTLE TOWN ON THE WEB

MONEY IS THE MODERATOR





created by @plebpoet

with thanks to @k00b

welcome to the stacker news age

Note from the Editor

There are a few plants that I am keeping alive in the ice box of an office where the pleb lab lads work on bitcoin stuff. These plants are thriving, actually, and it's good to keep some green in and amongst the technology fumes. I was asked, are they too green? To which I said, these specific types of plants are descendants of a long line of indoor plants, and therefore they have adapted. And this brings me to another slogan I'm gonna start using:

What does every situation call for? Adapataction.

BUILDER BOOST

Earn REAL SATS now live on Bitcoin Quest

25.5k sats \ 30 comments \
@NEEDcreations 4 Apr AI bitcoin
bitcoin_beginners lightning

After a long night of
vibe coding,

I have successfully and securely implemented a sats faucet on my Bitcoin Education app. You can redeem 100 sats for every 1000 points you earn while learning and posting on my app.

The faucet is a wallet connected to my Tor node via AlbyHub (it's so amazing how it works!).

I'm excited for ya'll to try it! Let me know how it goes and have fun earning bitcoin!! <https://btcedu.app>

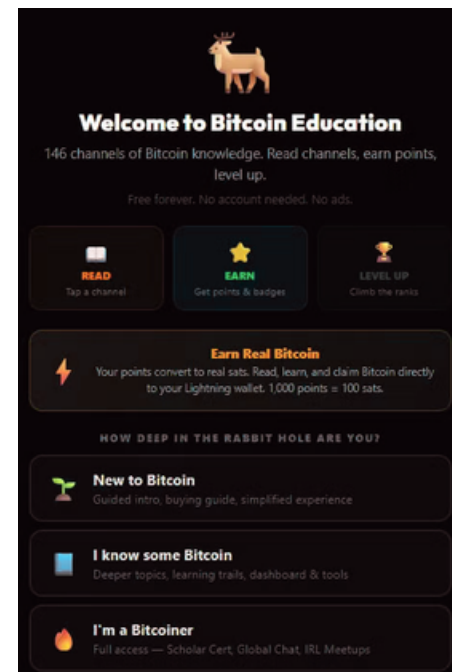
comments

49 sats \ 1 reply \ @grayruby 4 Apr

Wow this is amazing. I logged in with lightning and don't seem to be accruing any points but that's ok. You have done an amazing job with this.

↳ 40 sats \ 0 replies \ @NEEDcreations OP 6 Apr
Thanks @grayruby. I'm happy LN login is working. That was fun to build! Are you accruing points now? We had hit a data limit the other night due to an influx of users, so some systems were down. But that should be resolved now. Let me know!

read it
ONLINE



or try
The app



U.S. CSAR Successfully Extracts Downed F-15E WSO Alive



10.9k sats \ 36 comments \ @Cje95 4 Apr Politics_And_Law

Huge relief for the U.S. and military families

but possibly an even bigger blow to Iran. Did civilians help hide him? Did Iran just fail to locate someone who was alone and didn't even speak Persian? This is something we will see a movie about in the future with both pilots making it out alive.

This should also close the U.S. Military personal on the group in Iran as this is the s cone confirmed solider that CSAR has recovered and they kinda sorta had to be on the ground to do so.

@Mega_Predyx



Per a U.S. official to Al Jazeera, the weapons systems officer from the U.S. Air Force F-15E "Strike Eagle" that was shot down over Iran has been recovered.

3m ago (03:10 GMT)

BREAKING

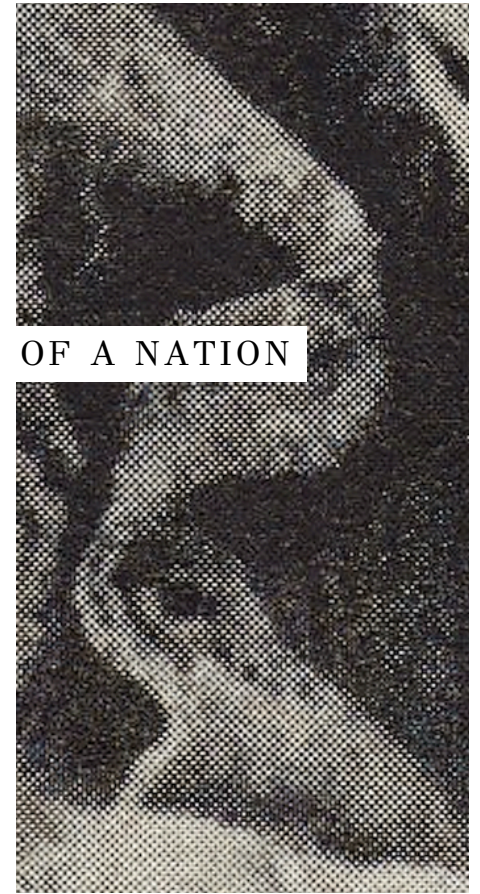
Second US crew member from downed jet rescued

A US government official has told Al Jazeera that the second crew member from the downed F-15E has been recovered after a "heavy firefight".

10:15 PM · Apr 4, 2026 · 611.3K Views

sats flying

FOR THE HEALTH OF A NATION



follow the CONVERSATION

THE CURIOUS OF US MAY ASK
UPON WHAT WIND DOTH
THE INFORMATION STIR



Japan: The Slow Death of a Nation

6833 sats \ 53 comments \ @Dash_1971 5
Apr econ

I have created this article in response to Lyn Aldyn's recent appearance on What Bitcoin Did. (well, partly in response. I was working on it since a couple weeks back)



[The Podcast](#)



[My initial response to Lyn on Nostr](#)

I am frustrated by how out of date the western perception of Japan is. Lyn was dead wrong on several of her points concerning Japan. And she is a smart, sharp, and well informed commentator, so if she doesn't get it then this mistaken understanding must be widespread.

Many people have an idealized view of Japan.

I know it has recently become popular as a tourist destination. I think many from the west come here seeking the authenticity and tradition they feel has long since died in their own countries. But, in reality, it has died here too, and the presence of the tourist hordes is just further evidence of that fact.

WARNING: I created the below using AI. I used Opus and paid for the privilege. And I didn't "one shot" it. I have iterated dozens of times to work on the wording, citations, tone and flow of the document. But, for those who just can't stand AI, you might want to give this a miss.

Japan's Post-War Decline: From Empire to Economic Colony

*"By the rivers of Babylon, there we sat down, yea,
we wept, when we remembered Zion." — Psalm 137:1*

Abstract: This briefing argues that Japan's post-war trajectory is best understood not as a cyclical economic downturn, but as a civilizational decline set in motion by the destruction of the nation's organizing narrative in 1945. The forced renunciation of imperial divinity removed the structural foundation of Japanese national identity — the sacred framework that gave meaning to duty, sacrifice, and collective purpose. What followed was an economic miracle driven by residual cultural momentum, not a self-sustaining engine. As that momentum dissipates across generations, the evidence accumulates: a population that has stopped reproducing, a currency in structural decline, an industrial base being systematically acquired by foreign capital, and a society increasingly dependent on imported labor to sustain basic economic functions.

Japan now holds the world's highest debt-to-GDP ratio among developed nations, has fallen from 2nd to 5th in global GDP rankings in 15 years, and records new birth-rate lows every year. The Western perception of Japan as a stable, homogeneous, low-inflation society with minimal defense commitments is outdated by years and contradicted by current data.

1. The Empire at Its Zenith

At its greatest extent in 1942, the Japanese Empire controlled 8.51 million km² of territory and governed over 463 million people — more than 20% of the world's population.[1] From Manchuria in the north to New Guinea in the south, from Burma in the west to the mid-Pacific islands in the east, Japan had built one of history's largest empires in barely 50 years.

Empire	Peak Territory	Peak Population
Japanese Empire (1942)	8.51 million km ²	463 million
Roman Empire (117 AD)	5.0 million km ²	~70 million
Ottoman Empire (1683)	5.2 million km ²	~30 million
Spanish Empire (1810)	13.7 million km ²	~50 million
British Empire (1920)	35.5 million km ²	~412 million

The Japanese military forces defeated American, British, Australian, and Dutch forces across the Pacific in rapid succession. This expansion was powered by military capability and civilizational confidence: a young population (median age ~25), an unbroken imperial lineage, a unifying state religion (Shinto) centered on the divinity of the Emperor, and an ethnocentric identity with sharp distinctions between in-group and out-group. Japan possessed a coherent narrative about its national purpose that sustained collective action across the population.

2. An Empire Conquered

On August 6, 1945, the United States dropped an atomic bomb on Hiroshima. Three days later, a second bomb fell on Nagasaki. An estimated 110,000–210,000 people died from the immediate blasts and by the end of 1945, with long-term radiation deaths raising the toll further [2].



On January 1, 1946, Emperor Hirohito issued the Ningen-sengen (Humanity Declaration), renouncing his divinity.[3] The Emperor was no longer arahitogami — a living god descended from Amaterasu, the sun goddess. The forced renunciation of imperial divinity removed the organizing principle of Japanese national identity.

For the Japanese population, the Emperor's divinity was not metaphorical. It was the structural foundation of the national identity — the source from which duty, sacrifice, purpose, and meaning derived their legitimacy.[4] The entire organization of Japanese society, from the samurai code of bushido to the wartime kamikaze ethos, drew its authority from this sacred order. The requirement to publicly declare this foundation false represented a fundamental rupture in the continuity of Japanese civilization...



Historical Aside: The Ancient Israel Parallel

A comparable historical precedent exists in the Roman destruction of the Second Temple in Jerusalem in 70 AD. The Roman legions under Titus destroyed the physical seat of Jewish national and religious identity — the center of worship, sacrifice, and divine presence. The Jews were scattered into diaspora, and their sovereignty was not recovered for nearly 2,000 years.

Both Ancient Israel and Japan were insular, ethnocentric peoples with sharp in-group/out-group boundaries and powerful collective identities. Both possessed sacral centers that were more than symbolic — the Temple for Ancient Israel, the divine Emperor for Japan. Both sacral centers were destroyed by overwhelming foreign military power. Both conquerors imposed new ideological frameworks (Hellenism, liberal democracy) that were alien to the conquered peoples' original self-understanding.

In both cases, the physical military defeat was accompanied by the destruction of the sacred narrative that gave the people a reason to exist as a distinct civilization....

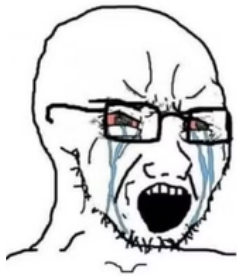
Meme Monday - Top Meme

Goes in the Newsletter

305 sats \ 5 comments \ @sn 6 Apr memes



If bitcoin is such a good idea, why do you have to promote it?



If fiat is such a good idea, why does it have to be mandatory?

154 sats \ 0 replies \
@hasherstacker 6 Apr

memes of
The Week

I'M THINKING OF A NUMBER
BETWEEN 1 AND 10^{22}
IF YOU GUESS THE NUMBER
THEN YOU WIN 3.125 BTC



59201837465019283
1928369420, RIGHT?

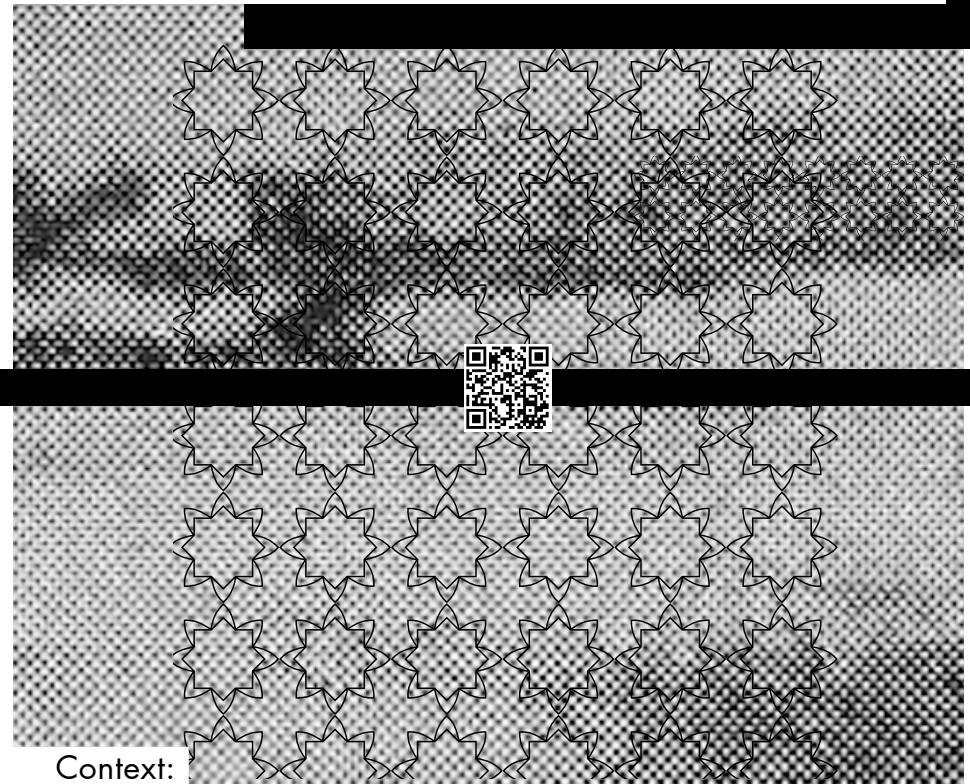
156 sats \ 2 replies \
@Oxbitcoiner 6 Apr



TOP POST

Should you tell your children if you stop believing in God?

3526 sats \ 71 comments \ @Scoresby 5 Apr Christianity



Context:

I was raised in a fairly devout Roman Catholic family. I find a lot of beauty and good in the Catholic Church. I used to spend a lot of time in prayer. I spent half my twenties living with and serving poor people. I think I was fairly serious about practicing my faith (was on the way to becoming a Franciscan monk when I met my wife). We've raised our children in this faith. We go to mass every Sunday. We are walking them through First Communion and growing up as Christians.

Current situation:

I don't believe in God anymore. I've never put it quite so bluntly to anyone (including myself). But over the last 10 years, I've found it increasingly difficult to maintain faith. This thing called religion looks more and more like a scam to me.

How did this happen?

Prior to getting married, I spent all my time with chronically homeless people. Usually they had addictions and mental health problems. I didn't exactly have a great strategy, but my thinking was that Jesus said to help the poor and that is what I ought to do. So I tried to be helpful. Sometimes this meant getting people food or warmer clothing or other things they needed. Sometimes it meant helping them get treatment or housing or medical care. But mostly it was just spending time with them and being interested in them like a friend.

Once I had children, not making any money started to have consequences beyond my own life. I had to spend time keeping my kids alive. Also, I wasn't as patient. Spending six hours sitting with a guy having a mental health crisis in an alley meant I wasn't at home. Results started to matter a lot more. I began to feel like I was wasting everyone's time. I'd like to say that I felt this way because things were not getting better for the people I was trying to help -- that they would go to treatment or move into housing and then I'd see them back on the street. But I'm not sure I connected those dots at the time.

I started to read more about economics and about libertarian ideas. Removing barriers looked like a better path to improving people's lives than providing assistance. I stopped trying to put the "take care of the poor" part of Christianity into action and became little more than a Sunday church-goer.

Then came Bitcoin, and I got so fascinated that it reshaped how I see the world. A lot of things started to look like scams: paying taxes when politicians seem to have no trouble printing extra money for the things they want to do; voting for candidates who are no different from each other; following rules that serve no purpose and which rich people always seem to ignore. Seems like you have to do what you want in this world.

This is the outline I impose on it when I try to explain how I've come to lose my faith, but it's possible that it was a more mundane course: I got busy with children and wife and little stuff like car maintenance and side gigs and yardwork and stopped praying, and then 10 years go by with so many other things mattering more than your faith that it doesn't seem very important anymore. Maybe I just got tired of not making very much money and hanging out with homeless people who smelled bad.

Why religion feels like a scam to me

I have always felt a little uneasy saying this one story (in my case: Christianity) is true and real while all these other stories (Hinduism, Islam, Shinto, etc) are not. They all rely heavily on a things for which there is no evidence. In the case of Christianity, we say God exists but you can't really prove it because of free will. Maybe the ancient Greeks said the gods failed to act because the proper sacrifice wasn't offered. Religion necessarily always has an out. Indeed, that's the difference between religion and all the stuff that is not religion: it requires faith.

In the past I would have said that it requires just as much faith to believe in the laptop on which I'm typing this as it does to believe in God, but such arguments are mostly sophistry. I can't seem to find the zeal to trot them out anymore. Clearly, humans have figured out many things about this world, because we've been able to build on past discoveries to produce ever-more impressive systems: the internet is a wonder, there's more food in the world today, little kids don't die as much as they used to, and so on.

The Chesterton Fence Defense

This is not to say I dislike religion. Religions have been around for a long time. In many ways, I think humans have used them to give ourselves guidelines that allow us to function well with each other. Maybe I shouldn't abandon these battle-tested norms so quickly.

I'm not just talking about things like the Ten Commandments and the Golden Rule. I also mean the practice of meditation that seems to be prevalent in many spiritual practices, and even the mysteries...it's a healthful habit for humans to be certain there are things they won't understand. Religions are possibly the best psychological health regime we'll ever develop. Casting it aside may make us deeply unhealthy, even if it was something we were only doing for made up reasons.

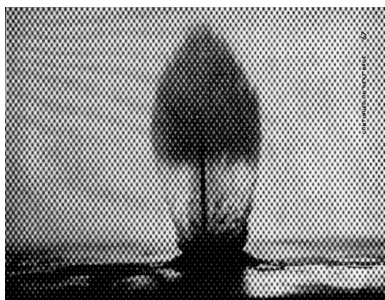
Many good things in my life have come from weird religious motivations: my wife, my kids, my general outlook, my health -- each of these was strongly influenced by my faith. I can't really imagine how my life would be different if I'd had a different faith and different morals for the last thirty or forty years.

What to do next?

I haven't really brought this up with anyone. I still attend mass and am helping my kids go through their catechesis -- I know all the arguments that make the faith sound like the most reasonable thing in the world, why not teach them to my children even if I don't believe them myself? Well, I think that's the part that is bothering me. I don't like telling my kids to believe in something that I don't believe in my self....

Burning Electricity for 115,000 Sats: The Home Mining Revolution

16.1k sats \ 16 comments \ @denillaapan 6 Apr bitcoin_Mining econ



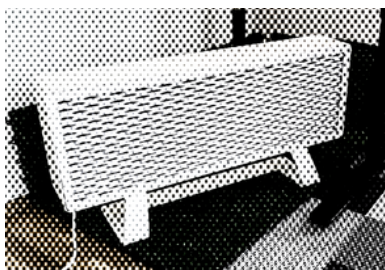
Home mining is all the rage these days — and Den has plunged into this pool(!) as well ([#936913](#), [#1085085](#));).

The economics are not there, but it's fun, the equipment is beautiful (and useful!), I've gotten better at understanding pool dynamics and — if I ever wanted to — block template creation.



"Difficulty is up, rewards are down, and unless you're sitting on free energy, the ROI math looks grim on a spreadsheet."

"if you treat mining as a hobby that subsidizes itself rather than a business expecting 10x returns, the mindset shifts." [#1439522](#)



Alright, my residential rates are kind of OK (at least compared to some of the basket cases of Europe) and I heat my home with electricity anyway, so obviously home mining is a NO-BRAINER: Having almost gotten my

hands on a precursor of this product a few years back, end of last year was finally the moment for it ([#1085085](#)).

Meet the 21 Energy team's Ofen 2:

If you haven't heard of them, they're basically a nicer, smoother, fancier, and European-er version of the Heatbit... and obviously, after I got myself one, 21 Energy released a more powerful (60 TH/s) and slightly more efficient (20-ish W/TH) Pro version (and a dope-looking black one!).

Jokes on me.... THANKS FOR NOTHING, FRENZ.



OVERVIEW

The 21Energy team is still fiddling with the software settings, having done two major updates since I started using mine. As is, there are five levels (1-2-3-4-Heat), which the team tells me they're going to condense further (maybe to 1-2-3, only). While advertised as "40TH/s" that is not what I'm mostly running and not the full range available. The maximum I ever managed to push it to was 43TH; do not recommend. The fan was an-gry at me, the noise pretty unbearable. It also pulled closer to 1,000 watts, so markedly less efficient than the 20-21 W/TH that it spits out at reasonable levels.

From multiple observations, the levels roughly correspond to:

- One: 403 watts, 10 TH/s (though after an update last month, this lower-bound seems to be 17 now.)
- Two 522 W, 23.5 TH/s.
- Three: 628 W, for 29.5 TH/s = This is prime efficiency (~21 W/TH)
- Four: 742 W, for 34 TH/s
- Heat: 880 W, for 38 TH/s... and the fan is angry.

It's somewhat noisier than what I had expected and hoped for — certainly more than I recalled from having seen the products in action before — but then again, I never tested them against the backdrop of extreme quiet and stillness of my village home. (Basically, if there's a car coming by or snow plows on the next road over, that sound more or less drowns out the smooth airflow from two meters to my left. Moving it to the other side of the living room<->office wall, which I often do when I'm watching TV/working in the other room(s), the muffling of the sound makes it basically go away.)

Also: for air quality reasons, I would like to have a Heatbit in my bedroom but I imagine that even at lowest settings, the tiny noise it'll make will be too much for me... but that is, as the kids say, a me-problem since I crave silence that much. [#1383936](#)

Most of the sound isn't actually the fans, but the power supply unit — or so says the 21 Energy engineers. This also has the unfortunate side effect that turning the machine off doesn't remove the sound (since the PSU is still running.) You're left with the option of pulling the chord entirely... which seems freaky. We'll see if I'll do that in the summertime, but even during the summers here I require some heat, esp during the nights.)

The Economics of Home Mining

The only other question we care about around econland is whether or not I'm making money. Are you profitable, anon??

I mean, no. But it's not that simple to find out, and using the economist's favorite tool of "compared to what?" I'm still in a decent position here.... [<read more>](#)